

## 1. Analyze the User's Request:

- Previous turn: The user asked for examples of face, degeneracy, and connection maps for  $n = 1, 2, 3$  based on a provided image/text. I provided a textual list of tuple mappings.
- Current turn: The user asks "what are the pictures look like".
- Intent: The user wants a visual/graphical representation of the mathematical structures described. Specifically, they want to know what the posets  $[1]^n$  look like as Hasse diagrams or geometric shapes, and how the maps  $\partial, \sigma, \gamma$  act on them visually.
- Constraint: I cannot generate images directly. I must describe them using text (ASCII art, mathematical diagrams, and textual descriptions of geometric shapes).

## 2. Deconstruct the Mathematical Objects:

- **Object:**  $[1]^n$ . This is the  $n$ -fold product of the poset  $[1] = \{0 \leq 1\}$ .
- **Geometric shape:** It represents the  $n$ -dimensional hypercube (also called  $n$ -cube) including the interior. Its elements are the vertices (corners) of the hypercube, represented by tuples of 0 and 1.
  - ■  $n = 0$ : A single point.
  - ■  $n = 1$ : A line segment (2 vertices: 0, 1).
  - ■  $n = 2$ : A square (4 vertices: (0, 0), (1, 0), (0, 1), (1, 1)).
  - ■  $n = 3$ : A cube (8 vertices).
- **Maps and their visual interpretation:**
  - **Faces ( $\partial$ ):** Maps  $n - 1$  dimensional cube to  $n$ -dimensional cube, embedding it as a boundary. In a square,  $\partial_{1,0}$  puts the 1D segment on the left side ( $x = 0$ ),  $\partial_{2,1}$  puts it on the top ( $y = 1$ ), etc.
  - **Degeneracies ( $\sigma$ ):** Maps  $n$ -cube to  $n - 1$ -cube by collapsing one dimension. For a cube, this is like projecting the square down to a line segment. The formula removes one coordinate.
  - **Connections ( $\gamma$ ):** Maps  $n$ -cube to  $n - 1$ -cube by identifying (folding) two adjacent faces. The formula applies max to two adjacent coordinates. This collapses a square into a line segment in a different way than degeneracy. Standard  $\sigma$  collapses a whole dimension (e.g.,  $x$  variable disappears), while  $\gamma$  folds along the diagonal of a face.

## 3. Formulate the Response Strategy:

- Acknowledge that I cannot generate actual pictures, but I can provide detailed descriptions and ASCII/Unicode diagrams.
- Describe the *shapes* for  $n = 1, 2, 3$  (Line, Square, Cube) using the standard hypercube visualization.
- Provide Hasse diagrams (poset diagrams) for  $[1]^n$  for  $n = 1, 2, 3$ . This shows the order relations (monotonicity) between tuples (e.g.,  $(0, 0) \leq (1, 0) \leq (1, 1)$ ).
- Describe visually where the face maps, degeneracies, and connections go.
  - For example,  $\sigma_1^2$  (removing  $x_1$ ) collapses a square into a line by projecting onto the  $y$ -axis.
  - $\gamma_1^2$  ( $\max\{x_1, x_2\}$ ) collapses a square into a line by folding it along the diagonal from (0, 1) to (1, 0).
- Use monospaced text format to create diagrammatic representations.

## 4. Drafting the Content (Mental Sandbox):

- *Hasse diagram of  $[1]^2$  (Square):*

```

(1,1)
 ^\
/  \

```

```

(1,0) (0,1)
 \ /
 /
(0,0)

```

Wait, strictly speaking in product poset:  $((0,0) \leq (1,0))$  and  $((0,0) \leq (0,1))$ , and  $((1,0) \leq (1,1))$ , and  $((0,1) \leq (1,1))$ . So it's a diamond shape.

\* \*Hasse diagram of  $[1]^3$  (Cube):\*

$(0,0,0)$  bottom. Goes up to  $(1,1,1)$  top. The next level has 3 nodes:  $(1,0,0)$ ,  $(0,1,0)$ ,  $(0,0,1)$ . The level below top has 3 nodes:  $(1,1,0)$ ,  $(1,0,1)$ ,  $(0,1,1)$ . It's a 3D diamond (a cube drawn schematically).

\* \*Visualizing maps:\*

\* For a square ( $n=2$ ):

- \*  $(\partial_{1,0})$  maps line to left edge.  $(\partial_{2,1})$  maps line to top edge.
- \*  $(\sigma_1)$  collapses the square horizontally (onto  $y$ -axis).  $(\sigma_2)$  collapses vertically (onto  $x$ -axis).
- \*  $(\gamma_1)$  collapses the square onto a line segment by folding along the anti-diagonal (from  $(0,1)$  to  $(1,0)$ ). Can describe it precisely.

## 5. Refine the Output:

- Structure clearly:  $n=1$ ,  $n=2$ ,  $n=3$ .
- Use text-based diagrams (ASCII art). The square and cube are easy to draw schematically.
- Match the definitions to the visual.

## 6. Writing the specific ASCII diagrams:

- **$n=1$ :**  
`0 <---> 1` (Just a line segment/arrow).
- **$n=2$  (Square):**

```

(1,0)  -----  (1,1)
 |              |
 |              |
(0,0)  -----  (0,1)

```

(Wait, the tuple notation:  $x_1$  is first,  $x_2$  is second. So  $(1,0)$  is right-bottom.  $(0,1)$  is left-top. Let's draw it properly).

Let's draw a standard coordinate plane.

```

      y
      ^
(0,1) --- (1,1)  (Top edge)
 |         |

```

$\begin{array}{c} | \\ (0,0) \text{ --- } (1,0) > x \text{ (Bottom edge)} \end{array}$

◦ **n=3 (Cube):**

Draw a cube wireframe. It's hard to do perfectly in ASCII, but I can do a standard projection. Or just describe the 3 levels of the Hasse diagram.

Level 0: (0,0,0)

Level 1: (1,0,0), (0,1,0), (0,0,1)

Level 2: (1,1,0), (1,0,1), (0,1,1)

Level 3: (1,1,1)

▪ **Let's try a projected ASCII cube:**

```

      (1, 0, 1)----- (1, 1, 1)
      /               /|
     /               /|
    (0, 0, 1)----- (0, 1, 1)
    |               |
    |               |
    |   (1, 0, 0)----- (1, 1, 0)
    |   /           /|
    |   /           /|
    (0, 0, 0)----- (0, 1, 0)
  
```

This is a good representation. Note that the coordinates aren't perfectly aligned to the edges, but it represents the combinatorial structure.

**7. Explain the Maps Visually:**

- **Faces ( $\partial$ ):** Embedding the lower dimension into the boundary.
  - In Square:  $\partial_{1,0}$  is the left vertical edge ( $x=0$ ),  $\partial_{1,1}$  is the right vertical edge ( $x=1$ ),  $\partial_{2,0}$  is the bottom horizontal edge ( $y=0$ ),  $\partial_{2,1}$  is the top horizontal edge ( $y=1$ ).
- **Degeneracies ( $\sigma$ ):** Projection. Pressing a 2D square flat onto a 1D line.
  - $\sigma_1^2$  projects a square onto the y-axis (drop  $x_1$ ). So (1, 0) and (1, 1) both map to (1). It's a vertical shadow.
  - $\sigma_2^2$  projects onto the x-axis (drop  $x_2$ ).
- **Connections ( $\gamma$ ):** Folding.
  - For a square,  $\gamma_1^2(x_1, x_2) = (\max(x_1, x_2))$ . This folds the square into a line segment.
  - Visual: Points (1, 0) and (0, 1) both map to (1). The square is folded along the diagonal line connecting (0, 1) and (1, 0). The diagonal line becomes the point (1) on the target line, while (0, 0) maps to (0) and (1, 1) maps to (1).

**8. Refine Tone and Clarity:**

- Make it clear I can't draw, but here's exactly how to draw it.
- Use bullet points and bold text for emphasis.
- Ensure the Hasse diagrams use standard poset conventions (lines denote  $\leq$  relations).

**9. Self-Correction/Verification on the "Picture" concept:**

- The user asked "what are the pictures look like" - literally. I'll start by clarifying the geometric interpretation of  $[1]^n$ .

- $[1]^1$  is a line segment.
- $[1]^2$  is a square.
- $[1]^3$  is a cube.
- The maps act on the *entire* cubical complex (vertices and interiors, though since it's a poset of tuples, the "interior" isn't visual unless we consider geometric realization).
- Wait, the text says "objects of  $\square$  are posets of the form  $[1]^n$ ". Yes, this is the cubical category (cubes). So  $[1]^n$  is the *geometric n-cube*. The faces, degeneracies, and connections are the structure maps of a cubical set.
- Let's emphasize the geometric realization: A line, a square, a cube.

10. **Final Polish:** Provide clear ASCII art for the 3 shapes ( $n=1, 2, 3$ ) and precise explanations of what the maps look like on them. Include the Hasse diagram for  $n = 3$  as well, or at least the coordinate mappings.

Let's write the final response now.

I cannot create or generate actual picture files, but I can describe exactly what these objects look like geometrically and provide precise ASCII/Unicode diagrams so you can visualize them.

These objects  $[1]^n$  are the **geometric  $n$ -cubes** (including their vertices). The "face," "degeneracy," and "connection" maps are the structural operations used to build, collapse, or fold these cubes.

Here is what the pictures look like for  $n = 1, 2$ , and 3:

## $n = 1$ : The Line Segment

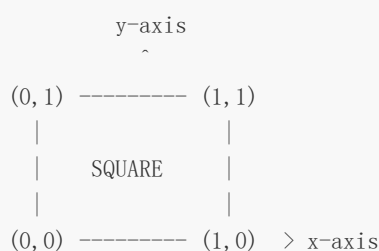
This is a 1-dimensional cube (an edge). It has two vertices: 0 and 1.

- **Diagram:**  $0 \text{ --- } 1$
- **Faces** ( $\partial_{1,0}, \partial_{1,1}$ ): Map a point ( $n = 0$ ) to the left vertex (0) or the right vertex (1).

## $n = 2$ : The Square

This is a 2-dimensional cube. It has four vertices  $(x_1, x_2)$ : (0, 0), (1, 0), (0, 1), (1, 1).

- **Visual (Coordinate Grid):**



- **Faces** ( $\partial$ ): These map a 1D segment to one of the 4 boundary edges of the square.
  - $\partial_{1,0}$ : Left edge (where  $x_1 = 0$ )

- $\partial_{1,1}$ : Right edge (where  $x_1 = 1$ )
- $\partial_{2,0}$ : Bottom edge (where  $x_2 = 0$ )
- $\partial_{2,1}$ : Top edge (where  $x_2 = 1$ )
- **Degeneracies ( $\sigma$ )**: These *collapse* the 2D square down to a 1D line segment (like casting a shadow).
  - $\sigma_1^2$ : Projects the square straight down onto the y-axis (dropping  $x_1$ ).
  - $\sigma_2^2$ : Projects the square straight sideways onto the x-axis (dropping  $x_2$ ).
- **Connections ( $\gamma$ )**: This folds the square into a 1D line segment, but differently than a projection.
  - $\gamma_1^2$ : This folds the square **along the diagonal** connecting  $(1, 0)$  and  $(0, 1)$ .
  - The point  $(0, 0)$  maps to 0,  $(1, 1)$  maps to 1, and the whole diagonal line  $(1, 0) \leftrightarrow (0, 1)$  folds down to become a single point (1).

## $n = 3$ : The Cube

This is a 3-dimensional cube. It has 8 vertices represented by tuples  $(x_1, x_2, x_3)$ .

- **Visual (3D Projection / Wireframe):**

```

      (1, 0, 1)------(1, 1, 1)
      /                   / |
     /                   /  |
(0, 0, 1)------(0, 1, 1) |
    |               |  |
    | (1, 0, 0)-----|---(1, 1, 0)
    | /               | /
    | /               | /
(0, 0, 0)------(0, 1, 0)
  
```

- **Faces ( $\partial$ )**: These embed a 2D square onto the boundaries of the 3D cube. There are 6 faces in total. For example:
  - $\partial_{1,0}$ : The left face ( $x_1 = 0$ ).
  - $\partial_{2,1}$ : The back face ( $x_2 = 1$ ).
  - $\partial_{3,0}$ : The bottom face ( $x_3 = 0$ ).
- **Degeneracies ( $\sigma$ )**: These squash the 3D cube down into a 2D square by collapsing one of the three dimensions. For example,  $\sigma_1^3$  drops the  $x_1$  coordinate, pressing the cube flat from left to right.
- **Connections ( $\gamma$ )**: These fold the 3D cube down to a 2D square. Instead of dropping a coordinate entirely, they glue two adjacent faces together (like folding the cube along an internal diagonal plane).

**(BONUS: If you want to visualize the underlying ordered structure (poset) for  $n = 3$ , it looks like a diamond graph:**

```

      (1, 1, 1)
      /   |   \
(1, 1, 0) (1, 0, 1) (0, 1, 1)
  \   \   |   /   /
   \   \   |   /   /
    \   \   |   /   /
  
```

$(1, 0, 0)$   $(0, 1, 0)$   $(0, 0, 1)$

$\backslash$   $|$   $/$   
 $\backslash$   $|$   $/$   
 $(0, 0, 0)$

*(Where the lines represent the monotone increase from 0 to 1 in coordinates).*